

Clean uninstall/Install of required packages.

The following is a step by step Guide to uninstall and reinstall Linux, Windows WSL, and docker-ce-cli on an undated Windows 11 platform. This assumes Docker Desktop was never installed.

1:48 PM

Claude responded: Uninstall

Uninstall

Step 1 — Shut Down WSL

In elevated PowerShell:

powershell

```
wsl --shutdown
```

Step 2 — Unregister & Destroy the Distro

powershell

```
wsl --list --verbose  
wsl --unregister Ubuntu
```

Step 3 — Remove WSL2

powershell

```
winget uninstall Microsoft.WSL  
  
dism.exe /online /disable-feature /featurename:Microsoft-Windows-Subsystem-Linux /norestart  
dism.exe /online /disable-feature /featurename:VirtualMachinePlatform /norestart
```

Step 4 — Clean Residual Files

powershell

```
Remove-Item "$env:LOCALAPPDATA\Packages\CanonicalGroupLimited*" -Recurse -Force -ErrorAction SilentlyContinue  
Remove-Item "$env:USERPROFILE\.wslconfig" -Force -ErrorAction SilentlyContinue  
Remove-Item "$env:USERPROFILE\.docker" -Recurse -Force -ErrorAction SilentlyContinue
```

Step 5 — Reboot

powershell

```
Restart-Computer
```

Step 6 — Verify Clean

powershell

```
wsl --list
```

Expected: "Windows Subsystem for Linux has no installed distributions"

Reinstall WSL2 and Ubuntu

Step 1 — Install WSL2 and Ubuntu

In elevated PowerShell:

powershell

```
wsl --install
```

Reboot when prompted. On first Ubuntu launch, create your username and password.

You may need to install 'Ubuntu 24.04 LTS'. Follow instructions to install it if Ubuntu fails to start from the Start menu or run.

```
wsl --install -d Ubuntu-24.04
```

Step 2 — Update Ubuntu

Inside the Ubuntu terminal:

bash

```
sudo apt update && sudo apt upgrade -y
```

Step 3 — Install Docker CE Prerequisites

bash

```
sudo apt install ca-certificates curl -y

sudo install -m 0755 -d /etc/apt/keyrings

sudo curl -fsSL https://download.docker.com/linux/ubuntu/gpg \
-o /etc/apt/keyrings/docker.asc

sudo chmod a+r /etc/apt/keyrings/docker.asc

echo \
"deb [arch=$(dpkg --print-architecture) \
signed-by=/etc/apt/keyrings/docker.asc] \
https://download.docker.com/linux/ubuntu \
$(. /etc/os-release && echo "$VERSION_CODENAME") stable" | \
sudo tee /etc/apt/sources.list.d/docker.list > /dev/null

sudo apt update
```

Step 4 — Install Docker CE

bash

```
sudo apt install docker-ce docker-ce-cli containerd.io docker-buildx-plugin  
docker-compose-plugin -y
```

Step 5 — Enable systemd

Required for Docker CE to run as a service in WSL2.

bash

```
sudo tee /etc/wsl.conf <<EOF  
[boot]  
systemd=true  
EOF
```

Then from PowerShell:

powershell

```
wsl --shutdown  
wsl
```

Step 6 — Start & Enable Docker Service

Back in the Ubuntu terminal:

bash

```
sudo systemctl enable docker  
sudo systemctl start docker
```

Step 7 — Add User to Docker Group

bash

```
sudo usermod -aG docker $USER  
newgrp docker
```

Step 8 — Verify & Login

bash

```
docker --version  
docker run hello-world  
docker login
```